



CREMA ITALIA™  
— ITALIAN ARTISAN COFFEE —

# Brand & Document Standards

Standard del marchio e dei documenti

| ISSUED BY                               | AUDIENCE                              | STATUS                       |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Crema Italia, LLC<br>Lutz, Florida, USA | Internal team<br>& brand contributors | Authoritative<br>Version 2.1 |

July 2026 · Version 2.1 · English

## THE CANONICAL REFERENCE

# Crema Italia Brand & Document Standards

Version 2.1 · July 2026 · Owner: Crema Italia, LLC · Lutz, Florida, USA · cremaitalia.com · Applies to: all Crema Italia documents (DOCX, PDF, Markdown), web pages, decks, email templates, and partner-facing collateral.

This is the canonical reference. When you ask a tool to build a Crema Italia document, slide, or web page, point it at this file and the accompanying `Crema Italia Brand CSS.css` and the finalized logo files in `Logo Assets/`. The look established by the Roaster Onboarding & Partnership Guide is the visual reference; this document codifies it.

## WHAT CHANGED IN V2.1 (2026-07-14)

One voice rule added (§9): **no em-dashes in customer-facing copy**, with the semicolon → spaced-hyphen and trailing → ellipsis substitutions. Color, type, logo, and layout grid are unchanged from v2.0; this is a copy-only minor revision.

## WHAT CHANGED IN V2.0 (ARTIST REBRAND, 2026-07-01)

A graphic artist delivered the finalized **Crema Italia™** mark (vector master + full lockup set) for the trademark filing. Two brand systems were revised as a result: the **palette** — Espresso Brown is now `#55331B` and Crema Gold is `#B88348` (replacing the former `#3B1F12` / `#C46A1F`); and the **type** — the wordmark is set in Montecatini Pro (in the logo art only), and live web/document headings use **Marcellus**, ending the earlier Cormorant→Lora display-font history. Green, red, cream, and Inter body type are unchanged.

## 1 · Brand essence

Crema Italia is a small, selective importer of artisan Italian coffee. The visual language must read as:

- **Editorial** — long-form, considered, like a fine-press book. Not e-commerce loud.
- **Italian** — a quiet nod to the tricolore (green / white / red) without ever shouting it.
- **Warm** — cream and coffee tones, never stark white, never grey corporate.
- **Bilingual-ready** — every layout must comfortably hold an English column and an Italian column side by side.

*When in doubt: fewer elements, more whitespace, smaller logo, larger margins.*

## 2 · Logo

**Files:** the finalized artist mark lives in `Logo Assets/` — a vector master ( `Art Files/*.ai` ) plus matched `EPS/` , `PDF/` , `SVG/` , `PNG/` exports and generated `Web/` derivatives. Three lockups — **main**

(vertical), **horizontal**, and **favicon** (cup only) — each in a light-background and a dark-background version.

- **Trademark:** the mark is **Crema Italia™**. The ™ sits as a cap-height superscript after the final "A" in "ITALIA." Never use ® — Crema Italia is not federally registered yet.
- **Clear space:** at least the height of the wordmark "C" on every side. Never crop the tricolore arcs.
- **Minimum size:** print 25 mm wide; screen 120 px wide. A favicon-only crop of the cup is acceptable below 120 px.
- **On dark backgrounds:** use the dark-background lockup (cream wordmark), e.g.  — never the light mark recolored. Never re-color the cup.
- **Don't:** stretch, rotate, or add drop-shadows; place on photographs without a solid backing; re-typeset the wordmark. Master edits happen in the ; re-export the others.

3 · Color system

All colors are derived from the finalized logo and its artist spec sheet. Use the role, not the hex name, when prompting.

3.1 Primary palette

| Role                                                                                                    | Hex     | RGB           | Where it lives                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------|
|  Background — Cream    | #FBF8F1 | 251, 248, 241 | Page background, document body, hero sections     |
|  Surface — Ivory       | #FFFFFF | 255, 255, 255 | Tables, callout cards, web cards on cream         |
|  Espresso — Brown      | #55331B | 85, 51, 27    | Body text, H1 headings, wordmark                  |
|  Espresso — Soft Brown | #6B4A38 | 107, 74, 56   | Muted / secondary body, captions (interim)        |
|  Crema — Gold          | #B88348 | 184, 131, 72  | H2 / sub-headings, accents, links, key numbers    |
|  Crema Light           | #E8A86A | 232, 168, 106 | Hover states, light fills, chart shades (interim) |

Interim tokens (Espresso Soft, Crema Light, and hover #9C6E3C ) are harmonizations pending re-derivation from the two artist hero tones.

3.2 Italian flag accents (use sparingly)

| Role                                                                                                | Hex     | RGB         | Where it lives                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
|  Tricolore Green | #0E7A3A | 14, 122, 58 | Top-left page rule, footer bar, ENGLISH column markers   |
|  Tricolore Red   | #C8342B | 200, 52, 43 | Top-right page rule, footer bar, ITALIANO column markers |

The flag colors are **decorative rules, never large fills**. Think: a pencil-thick rule across the top of the page, a 6 mm strip at the foot of the cover. Never block colors.

3.3 Neutral / structural

| Role                                                                                         | Hex     | Use                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
|  Hairline | #D9D2C2 | Column dividers, table borders, footer rules                  |
|  Mute     | #8C7E6A | Page numbers, footer text, eyebrow labels (ENGLISH, ITALIANO) |
|  Ink soft | #5A4A3F | Long-form body text where pure brown is too heavy             |

3.4 Contrast — non-negotiable

| Pair (on Cream #FBF8F1) | Ratio    | Status                                                        |
|-------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Espresso Brown #55331B  | 10.6 : 1 | AAA                                                           |
| Espresso Soft #6B4A38   | 7.4 : 1  | AAA                                                           |
| Ink soft #5A4A3F        | 8.0 : 1  | AAA                                                           |
| Crema Gold #B88348      | 3.1 : 1  | <b>Large display only</b> — ≥ 18 pt / 24 px (or bold ≥ 14 pt) |
| Mute #8C7E6A            | 3.7 : 1  | Captions / fine print only                                    |

**Rule:** Crema Gold’s contrast on cream (3.1 : 1) is lower than the terracotta it replaced — it clears WCAG only for **large text**. Use gold for large headings, short bold accent runs, links, and key numerals; **never** body copy or small text. When a gold element could fall below ~18 px, set it in Espresso Brown instead.

3.5 Don’t introduce new colors

If a chart or web feature seems to need a new hue, derive it from Crema Light, Espresso, or a desaturated Tricolore Green. The brand should never sprout a sixth or seventh accent.

## 4 · Typography

Two live families plus the logo face. Hold this line — the document brand depends on it.

### 4.1 The pairing

| Role               | Family                              | Where to use                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logo wordmark      | Montecatini Pro (Normale Semi-Bold) | Logo artwork <b>only</b> — already outlined in the files. Commercial font; licensing unconfirmed for any use beyond the outlined mark. |
| Display & Headings | Marcellus (serif, weight 400)       | Cover title, H1, section headings, web/document display. The free Google-Font stand-in for Montecatini.                                |
| Body & UI          | Inter (sans, 400 / 500 / 600)       | All body text, tables, captions, web UI, buttons, tagline.                                                                             |

**Why this pairing:** Marcellus echoes the classical Roman capitals of the wordmark and reads as considered and Italian without theatrics; Inter is a calm, neutral workhorse that handles bilingual copy and small sizes without strain. Both are free, web-safe, and embed cleanly in PDF.

**Marcellus is roman-only** — it ships a single 400 weight with no italic. Two consequences: (1) heading *hierarchy is set by size, not weight*; use bold Inter for emphasis within text. (2) The English-vs-Italian cue is now carried by the **ENGLISH / ITALIANO** eyebrow label and column position — *not* by italic display type. Reserve italics (Inter Italic) for references and short foreign words.

### 4.2 Sub-heading exception

H2 sub-headings are set in **Inter SemiBold (600) in Crema Gold**, not in serif. Keep this rule — it visually separates major editorial titles (Marcellus, brown) from in-page section markers (Inter, gold).

### 4.3 Word & PDF — exact specifications

| Element                    | Family       | Wt      | Size             | Color                 | Lead |
|----------------------------|--------------|---------|------------------|-----------------------|------|
| Cover title                | Marcellus    | 400     | 30–36 pt         | Espresso #55331B      | 1.1  |
| Cover sub-title (Italian)  | Marcellus    | 400     | 15–18 pt         | Espresso Soft #6B4A38 | 1.2  |
| H1 page heading            | Marcellus    | 400     | 22–24 pt         | Espresso #55331B      | 1.15 |
| H2 sub-heading             | Inter        | 600     | 13 pt            | Crema Gold #B88348    | 1.25 |
| Eyebrow (ENGLISH/ITALIANO) | Inter        | 600     | 8.5 pt, +0.12 em | Crema Gold #B88348    | 1.0  |
| Body                       | Inter        | 400     | 10.5 pt          | Espresso #55331B      | 1.45 |
| Body emphasis              | Inter        | 600     | 10.5 pt          | Espresso #55331B      | 1.45 |
| Caption / reference        | Inter Italic | 400     | 9 pt             | Espresso Soft #6B4A38 | 1.4  |
| Table header               | Inter        | 600     | 9.5 pt           | Cream on Espresso     | 1.3  |
| Table body                 | Inter        | 400     | 9.5 pt           | Espresso #55331B      | 1.4  |
| Footer / page no.          | Inter        | 400/500 | 8.5 pt           | Mute #8C7E6A          | 1.3  |

#### 4.4 Web — exact specifications

| Element         | Family    | Wt  | Size                                  | Color         |
|-----------------|-----------|-----|---------------------------------------|---------------|
| Hero / cover    | Marcellus | 400 | 4.5 rem / 72 px                       | Espresso      |
| H1              | Marcellus | 400 | 2.5 rem / 40 px                       | Espresso      |
| H2              | Inter     | 600 | 1.125 rem / 18 px                     | Crema Gold    |
| H3              | Inter     | 600 | 1 rem / 16 px                         | Espresso      |
| Body            | Inter     | 400 | 1.0625 rem / 17 px                    | Espresso      |
| Small / caption | Inter     | 400 | 0.875 rem / 14 px                     | Espresso Soft |
| Eyebrow         | Inter     | 600 | 0.75 rem / 12 px, +0.12 em, uppercase | Crema Gold    |

#### 4.5 Body type rules

- **Measure:** 65–75 characters per line. In a two-column bilingual Letter layout this lands at ~3.1 in / 7.9 cm column width.
- **Paragraph spacing:** 6 pt before, no first-line indent. Never both indent and space.
- **Hyphenation:** off for English and Italian; a slightly ragged right reads better, and Italian breaks awkwardly.
- **Numerals:** lining, tabular in tables and prices; proportional elsewhere.
- **Italics carry meaning** — Italian-language references and short foreign words (Inter Italic). Don't italicize for emphasis; use bold.

## 4.6 Font fallbacks

Display: "Marcellus", "Georgia", serif · Body: "Inter", "Helvetica Neue", "Arial", sans-serif . For Word documents, ship Marcellus and Inter as embedded named styles; if a recipient lacks them, Word falls back to Georgia and Calibri — close enough to preserve hierarchy.

# 5 · Page layout

## 5.1 Document grid (Letter — 8.5 × 11 in)

| Margin                             | Size    |
|------------------------------------|---------|
| Top / Bottom                       | 0.85 in |
| Left & Right                       | 0.75 in |
| Gutter (between bilingual columns) | 0.4 in  |
| Column width (each)                | 3.55 in |

## 5.2 Page chrome

- **Top:** two short rules — green #0E7A3A left, red #C8342B right, ~1.6 in long, 1.2 pt thick. Wordmark “Crema Italia” sits left in 9–11 pt Marcellus; running title sits right in 9 pt Inter.
- **Bottom:** single hairline rule #D9D2C2, 0.5 pt. Below it, footer “Crema Italia, LLC · Lutz, Florida, USA · cremaitalia.com” left, “Page N” right, both 8.5 pt Inter Mute.
- **Cover:** logo top-center, centered title block, three-column meta strip (Issued by / Audience / Status) above a hairline, and a 6 mm green-cream-red flag strip at the foot.

## 5.3 Bilingual columns

- Always English left, Italian right.
- Column eyebrow labels (ENGLISH, ITALIANO) in Crema Gold, set above the H1.
- A 0.5 pt hairline runs the full text height between columns.
- Because Marcellus has no italic, the English/Italian distinction is carried by the eyebrow label and column position — not by italic display type (a change from v1.0).

## 5.4 Lists, tables, callouts

- **Bulleted lists:** • (U+2022), 0.18 in indent, 0.12 in hanging indent. No nested bullets in body content; if you need a second level, restructure into a table.
- **Tables:** Espresso-brown header bar #55331B with cream text; body rows on Ivory #FFFFFF; row separators #D9D2C2. No vertical lines.
- **Callouts:** cream box #FBF8F1 on ivory page, 1 pt left rule in Crema Gold #B88348, 0.25 in inner padding.
- **References:** italic caption style, prefixed “Reference:” / “Riferimento:”.

## 6 · Web styling

The accompanying `Crema Italia Brand CSS.css` (v1.2) is the canonical implementation. It exposes every value above as a CSS custom property and includes ready-made classes for `.eyebrow`, `.bilingual`, `.callout`, `.flag-rule`, and `.btn-primary`.

### 6.1 Web rules

- Max content width 72 ch for long-form, 1120 px for landing pages.
- Load fonts: `Marcellus` + `Inter` from Google Fonts.
- Buttons: Crema Gold fill, Cream text, 8 px radius, 12 px / 24 px padding, no shadow.
- Hover: darken Crema by ~8% — `--ci-crema-hover: #9C6E3C`.
- Focus ring: 2 px Crema Gold with 2 px Cream offset — required for accessibility.
- Never animate gratuitously. A 200 ms color transition on links is the ceiling.

## 7 · Data visualization

- Single-series: Crema Gold `#B88348`.
- Two-series: Crema Gold `#B88348` and Espresso Soft `#6B4A38`.
- Three-to-five series: Crema Gold, Espresso Soft, Tricolore Green `#0E7A3A`, Espresso Brown `#55331B`, Crema Light `#E8A86A` — in that order.
- Background: Cream. Gridlines: Hairline `#D9D2C2`, dashed, 0.5 pt. Axis labels: Inter 9 pt, Mute.
- Title above the chart in Inter SemiBold 11 pt Espresso — state the insight, not the variable.
- No 3D, no pie charts with more than 3 wedges, no dual axes.

## 8 · Imagery & photography

- **Style:** natural light, low saturation, narrow depth of field. Espresso cups, roasting drums, hands at work, Tuscan landscape.
- **Don't:** stock photos of generic baristas, vector illustrations, emoji, decorative coffee-bean borders.
- **Treatment:** images sit on Cream with a 1 px Hairline border and 0.25 in margin. No drop-shadows.
- **Aspect ratios:** 3:2 landscape product shots, 1:1 roaster portraits, 16:9 hero web banners.

## 9 · Voice & tone (brief)

- **Plain, direct, deferential.** “We choose a small number of roasters whose work represents the craft of Italian roasting at its best.” Not: “We hand-pick the world’s most exclusive coffee artisans.”
- **Bilingual parity.** Every roaster-facing artifact ships in English and Italian. Italian is the controlling version when handed to an Italian roaster.
- **Honour formal address in Italian.** Use Voi / Vi / Vostro, capitalized.
- **Numbers and units.** Always include both metric (250 g, 1 kg) and U.S. customary (8.82 oz, 2.20 lb) on weight references.
- **No em-dashes in customer-facing copy.** Storefront and marketing text — product and page copy, forms, email templates, the coming-soon page — never uses the em-dash, which reads as machine-written. Where a semicolon would serve, use a spaced hyphen ( - ); where a sentence trails into a follow-on thought, use an ellipsis ( ... ); if a case is genuinely ambiguous, ask. Customer-facing copy only — internal documents, this one included, may still use them.

## 10 · File naming & versioning

- Documents: Crema\_Italia\_<Topic>\_v<MAJOR>.<MINOR>.{docx|pdf} .
- Logos: organized by lockup and format in Logo Assets/ — Art Files/ (.ai master), EPS/ , PDF/ , SVG/ , PNG/ , Web/ . Lockups: main, horizontal, favicon — each light and dark.
- CSS / templates: Crema Italia Brand CSS.css , kept under version control.
- Increment minor (2.0 → 2.1) for copy fixes. Increment major (2.x → 3.0) for any change to color, type, or layout grid.
- Always use the greatest version-number variant of a file ( \_v2 > \_v1 ).

## 11 · Quick checklist before sharing any artifact

- Logo: correct file & lockup, clear space respected, minimum size honored, ™ present (never ®).
- Background is Cream #FBF8F1, not white (except inside tables/cards).
- Headings in Marcellus, body in Inter; wordmark artwork only in Montecatini.
- Crema Gold used only on large headings, links, key numerals — never body or small text.
- Tricolore green and red appear only as thin rules, never as fills.
- Bilingual layout: English left, Italian right; English/Italian cue via eyebrow label, not italic.
- Footer carries “Crema Italia, LLC · Lutz, Florida, USA · cremaitalia.com”; page numbers present.
- Body type ≥ 10.5 pt (print) / 17 px (web); contrast checked (gold large-only).

- No introduced colors, no decorative graphics, no stretched logo.

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Document maintained by Crema Italia, LLC. Companion files: [Crema Italia Brand CSS.css](#) (v1.2), the finalized logo set in [Logo Assets/](#), and this document's editable source [Crema\\_Italia\\_Brand\\_Standards\\_v2.1.html](#). Supersedes Brand Standards v2.0 (July 2026) and v1.0 (May 2026).